Amer Sports Inc. (AS)

4Q25 Earnings Review: Broad-based revenue momentum balanced by higher investments

AS	12m Price Target: **$48.00**	Price: **$38.24**	Upside: **25.5%**

BUY

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AS reported a 4Q EPS beat, with broad-based revenue strength across brands, channels, regions, and categories partially offset by higher SG&A investments at the Salomon brand. Looking ahead, management introduced formal FY26 guidance of mid-teens ex-FX revenue growth (16-18% reported), though operating margins were guided towards the low end of the company's long-term algorithm (30-50bps Y/Y expansion) and below prior FactSet consensus expectations.

Amidst a backdrop of elevated investor expectations, the key surprise today was the accelerated pace of SG&A investment for Salomon brand and a more muted consolidated profit guide (with the company pointing margin expansion to the low end of the company's long-term algorithm). We view the investments as prudent and strategic, and do not view the accelerated investments as a structural shift in the long-term arc of earnings growth opportunity for the company overall. However, it does point to a modestly more muted near-term earnings growth picture vs. our prior expectation.

We step away from the quarter encouraged by the healthy growth momentum (here, management commentary suggests strength has continued 1QTD). The company continues to demonstrate solid revenue growth momentum, with strong double digit growth across all geographies, broad-based comp delivery across brands, and rising brand awareness following the company's strategic investments. We do acknowledge the key offsets in the quarter including: (1) An accelerated near-term pace of SG&A investments; (2) Mix impacts limiting gross margin outperformance in 4Q; (3) Continued near-term margin pressure as a result of Y/Y comparisons and growth investments; and (4) A more muddled operating profit narrative as a result of corporate expense reclassification. That said, we view these as largely strategic and indicative of investments behind opportunities across products,

Key Data

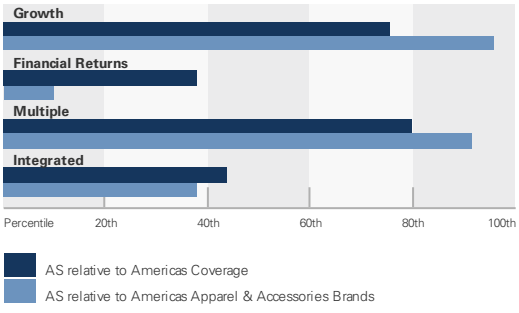
Market cap: $21.6bn
Enterprise value: $21.5bn
3m ADTV: $147.9mn
United States
Americas Apparel & Accessories Brands
M&A Rank: 3

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue ($ mn) New	**6,566.2**	**7,759.9**	**8,752.6**	**9,776.1**
Revenue ($ mn) Old	6,449.5	7,478.0	8,414.2	–
EBITDA ($ mn)	1,150.7	1,381.3	1,621.4	1,887.0
EBIT ($ mn)	837.7	1,026.1	1,215.3	1,424.6
EPS ($) New	**0.97**	**1.17**	**1.47**	**1.78**
EPS ($) Old	0.94	1.21	1.49	–
P/E (X)	34.2	32.6	26.0	21.5
Dividend yield (%)	–	–	–	–
Net debt/EBITDA (X)	0.2	(0.1)	(0.5)	(0.9)

	12/25	3/26E	6/26E	9/26E
EPS ($)	0.31	0.30	0.07	0.38

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
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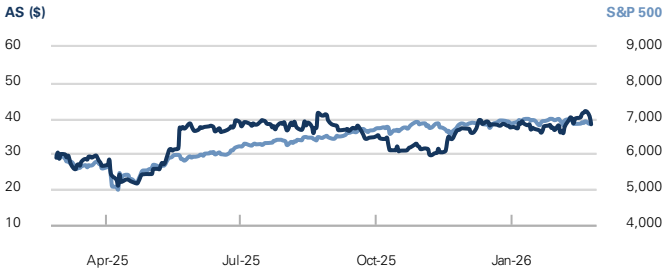
Ratios & Valuation

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
P/E (X)	34.2	32.6	26.0	21.5
EV/EBITDA (X)	16.3	15.4	12.7	10.5
EV/sales (X)	2.8	2.7	2.4	2.0
FCF yield (%)	1.6	1.8	3.0	4.1
EV/DACF (X)	23.3	19.3	16.1	13.3
CROCI (%)	10.0	12.6	13.7	14.9
ROE (%)	7.8	10.2	11.5	12.3
Net debt/EBITDA (X)	0.2	(0.1)	(0.5)	(0.9)
Net debt/equity (%)	4.9	(1.4)	(10.1)	(19.4)
Interest cover (X)	7.0	8.4	12.4	14.6
Inventory days	186.7	198.1	199.8	199.1
Receivable days	39.4	41.5	42.4	42.6
Days payable outstanding	86.5	94.4	96.1	96.6

Growth & Margins (%)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue growth	26.7	18.2	12.8	11.7
EBITDA growth	45.9	25.7	17.6	16.5
EPS growth	106.3	20.7	25.4	20.8
DPS growth	NM	NM	NM	NM
Gross margin	57.6	58.8	59.5	60.3
EBIT margin	10.7	12.5	13.3	14.0

Price Performance



	3m	6m	12m
Absolute	6.1%	(7.8)%	33.7%
Rel. to the S&P 500	4.0%	(12.8)%	17.0%

Source: FactSet. Price as of 24 Feb 2026 close.

Income Statement ($ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue	6,566.2	7,759.9	8,752.6	9,776.1
Cost of goods sold	(2,781.9)	(3,197.5)	(3,541.6)	(3,883.8)
SG&A	(3,104.6)	(3,609.2)	(4,068.6)	(4,540.5)
R&D	–	–	–	–
Other operating inc./(exp.)	22.1	20.0	20.0	20.0
EBITDA	**1,086.0**	**1,365.3**	**1,605.4**	**1,871.0**
Depreciation & amortization	(384.2)	(392.0)	(442.9)	(499.2)
EBIT	**701.8**	**973.3**	**1,162.5**	**1,371.8**
Net interest inc./(exp.)	(77.3)	(107.1)	(77.5)	(65.7)
Income/(loss) from associates	–	–	–	–
Pre-tax profit	**611.5**	**866.2**	**1,084.9**	**1,306.1**
Provision for taxes	(184.1)	(242.5)	(292.9)	(339.6)
Minority interest	–	–	–	–
Preferred dividends	–	–	–	–
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	**427.4**	**623.7**	**792.0**	**966.5**
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	**545.1**	**661.7**	**830.5**	**1,005.6**
EPS (basic, pre-except) ($)	**0.77**	**1.12**	**1.41**	**1.72**
EPS (diluted, pre-except) ($)	**0.76**	**1.10**	**1.40**	**1.71**
EPS (ex-ESO exp., dil.) ($)	**--**	**--**	**--**	**--**
DPS ($)	–	–	–	–
Div. payout ratio (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Wtd avg shares out. (basic) (mn)	555.6	558.5	560.0	561.3
Wtd avg shares out. (diluted) (mn)	561.4	564.6	565.1	566.4

Balance Sheet ($ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Cash & cash equivalents	652.3	945.7	1,597.1	2,478.5
Accounts receivable	809.3	956.4	1,078.8	1,204.9
Inventory	1,622.1	1,848.4	2,029.7	2,206.3
Other current assets	220.3	256.7	286.9	318.1
Total current assets	**3,304.0**	**4,007.3**	**4,992.4**	**6,207.9**
Net PP&E	1,461.2	1,579.3	1,672.0	1,733.8
Net intangibles	5,120.3	5,083.9	5,024.6	4,939.9
Total investments	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Other long-term assets	178.9	178.9	178.9	178.9
Total assets	**10,064.4**	**10,849.4**	**11,867.9**	**13,060.5**
Accounts payable	769.8	884.8	980.0	1,074.7
Short-term debt	142.8	142.8	142.8	142.8
Current lease liabilities	157.1	172.3	188.0	203.7
Other current liabilities	1,139.5	1,139.5	1,139.5	1,139.5
Total current liabilities	**2,209.2**	**2,339.4**	**2,450.3**	**2,560.7**
Long-term debt	792.3	709.9	709.9	709.9
Non-current lease liabilities	660.9	719.4	780.1	840.7
Other long-term liabilities	581.1	581.1	581.1	581.1
Total long-term liabilities	**2,034.3**	**2,010.4**	**2,071.1**	**2,131.7**
Total liabilities	**4,243.5**	**4,349.8**	**4,521.4**	**4,692.4**
Preferred shares	–	–	–	–
Total common equity	**5,802.0**	**6,480.7**	**7,327.7**	**8,349.2**
Minority interest	18.9	18.9	18.9	18.9
Total liabilities & equity	**10,064.4**	**10,849.4**	**11,867.9**	**13,060.5**
BVPS ($)	10.40	11.59	13.07	14.86

Cash Flow ($ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Net income	440.4	623.7	792.0	966.5
D&A add-back	384.2	392.0	442.9	499.2
Minority interest add-back	–	–	–	–
Net (inc)/dec working capital	(54.5)	(294.8)	(238.6)	(239.3)
Others	(40.1)	55.0	55.0	55.0
Cash flow from operations	**730.0**	**775.8**	**1,051.3**	**1,281.5**
Capital expenditures	(333.3)	(400.0)	(400.0)	(400.0)
Acquisitions	–	–	–	–
Divestitures	–	–	–	–
Others	–	–	–	–
Cash flow from investing	**(333.3)**	**(400.0)**	**(400.0)**	**(400.0)**
Dividends paid	–	–	–	–
Share issuance/(repurchase)	0.0	0.0	–	–
Inc/(dec) in debt	0.8	(82.4)	–	–
Others	2.6	–	–	–
Cash flow from financing	**(89.8)**	**(82.4)**	**0.0**	**0.0**
Total cash flow	**306.9**	**293.4**	**651.3**	**881.5**
Free cash flow	396.7	375.8	651.3	881.5
Free cash flow per share (basic) ($)	0.55	0.67	1.16	1.57

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

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categories, and brands. We continue to see AS one of the most differentiated growth stories in our coverage universe, where accelerating growth momentum at the Salomon brand (for both sportstyle and performance product) and a stronger Tennis 360 softgoods business at the Wilson business is increasingly delivering a three-pillar growth platform. Net, we believe that AS's continued innovation-led momentum is best-in-class, and see core structural drivers of growth ahead (new store investments / key category expansion such as women's, footwear, and performance product / new distribution expansion opportunity / emerging momentum in North America and Western markets), all of which provide healthy line of sight to future earnings growth. Stay Buy.

What Happened?

4Q result: AS reported adjusted 4Q EPS of $0.31, above GS/FactSet consensus at $0.28. Revenue increased 28.4% Y/Y, ahead of GS/consensus at 21.3%/21.9%, with the beat driven by outperformance across all segments. Adjusted gross margin expanded ~140bps Y/Y to 57.8%, in line with GSe and above consensus at 57.7%, but adjusted EBIT margin of 12.5% came in below GS/consensus estimates of 13.3%/12.9%.

FY26 guidance: AS initiated formal FY26 guidance (beyond the initial guardrails given last quarter), where the company expects adj. EPS of $1.10-$1.15 (vs. GS/consensus at $1.21/$1.16, respectively). The company now expects revenue growth of 16-18% (inclusive of 200bps of favorable FX, which compares to prior commentary suggesting the high end of +LDD% to mid-teens%), which compares to GS/consensus at +15.9%/+16.3%, respectively. Management also expects adj. operating margin of 13.1% to 13.3%, implying ~30-50bps Y/Y expansion, which compares to prior guardrails of in line with the company's long-term algo of +30-70bps annual operating margin expansion (vs. GS/consensus estimates for ~70bps/~80bps expansion, respectively). By segment, management expects Technical Apparel revenues to grow 18-20% and operating margin of 22%, Outdoor Performance sales to increase 18-20% and operating margin of 14.5-14.8%, and Ball & Racquet revenues to grow 7-9% and operating margin of 4.7-5.0%. That said, a change in corporate expense allocation makes prior consensus segment operating margins non-comparable.

Estimates, Valuation, and Key Risks

We update our FY26/FY27 EPS estimates to $1.17/$1.47 from $1.21/$1.49 prior to reflect stronger revenue growth momentum across brands, a higher pace of SG&A investment, management's latest outlook for 2026 new store growth, and other minor adjustments to our margin forecasts. We also introduce our FY28 EPS estimate of $1.78. Our 12-month price target of $48 is unchanged as we roll forward our Q5-Q8 valuation methodology on our updated estimates, and we lower our target Q5-Q8 EV/EBITDA valuation multiple to 19x from 21x prior to reflect a slower pace of margin flow-through vs. our prior expectations.

Key downside risks include: (1) Slower-than-anticipated growth in the Greater China market; (2) Weaker brand momentum due to slower innovation; (3) Corporate structure, including the company's Cayman Islands incorporation and shifts in support from several majority shareholders; and (4) Lower real estate availability or quality.

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Reg AC

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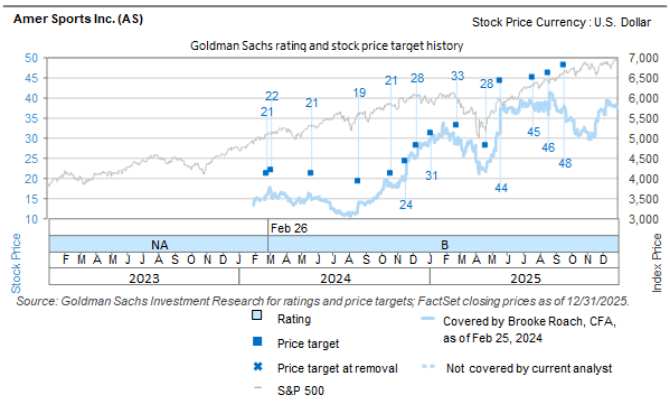
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